The Fourth Sheet

Example report · Not-for-profits

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

What does it cost to raise a dollar?

Period: October 2026 to date. What fundraising costs (grant writing, donor campaigns, events) for every dollar it brings in. Pick a source and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

October 2026 Incomplete October 2026 is still in progress: figures to 6 Oct only.

In short: Each dollar raised cost 9¢ in October so far, and 15¢ a dollar this financial year to date.

Source: All fundraising

October so far · all fundraising
9¢
September 20¢

Year to date (Jul to Oct 2026)
15¢
same period last year: 15¢

Cost to raise a dollar, by source, October 2026 to date (cents)



What it shows
October so far cost 9¢ to raise each dollar, against 20¢ in September. This financial year to date it has cost 15¢ a dollar, against 15¢ in the same period last year. October is still in progress (data to 6 October), so it is a part month against full months.

What you'd do about it
The year-to-date figure is steadier than single months: events make some months jump. Pick a source above to see which one moves it.

Source: Grants

October so far · Grants
9¢
September 9¢

Year to date (Jul to Oct 2026)
10¢
same period last year: 11¢

What it shows
Grants cost 10¢ to raise each dollar this financial year to date ($22,316 of grant writing and reporting for $234,325), against 11¢ in the same period last year.

What you'd do about it
Usually the cheapest money to raise, as long as the time that goes into applications and acquittals is protected.

Source: Donations

October so far · Donations
10¢
September 19¢

Year to date (Jul to Oct 2026)
16¢
same period last year: 14¢

What it shows
Donations cost 16¢ to raise each dollar this financial year to date ($10,115 of donor campaigns for $63,894), against 14¢ in the same period last year.

What you'd do about it
Steady and cheap, and untied: the money that builds reserves.

Source: Fundraising events

October so far · Fundraising events

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September 41¢

Year to date (Jul to Oct 2026)

46¢

same period last year: 41¢

What it shows

Fundraising events cost 46¢ to raise each dollar this financial year to date ($19,300 of event costs for $41,600), against 41¢ in the same period last year.

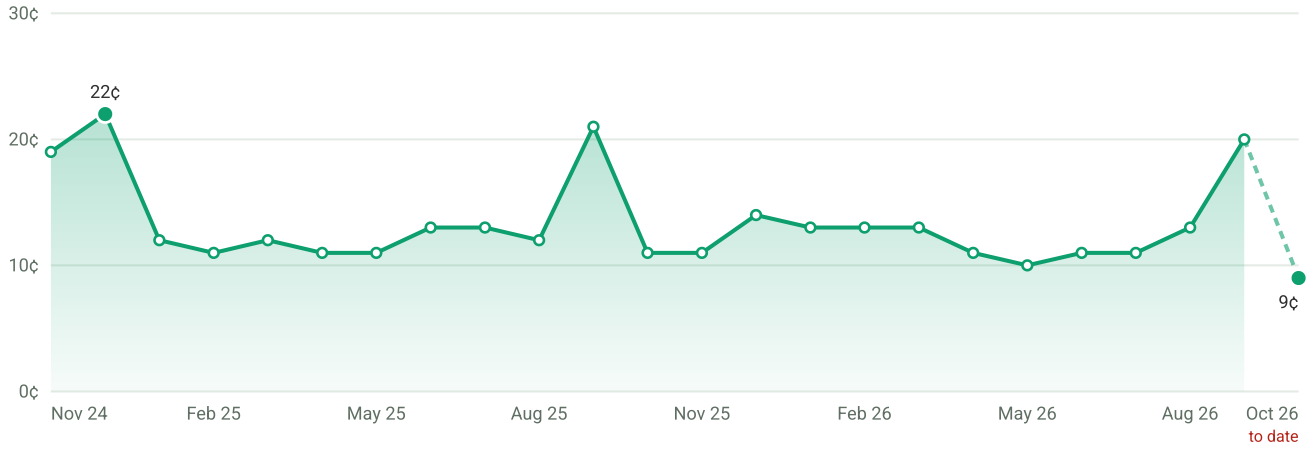
What you'd do about it

Usually the dearest money to raise: events are worth counting for what else they bring too (new donors, profile).

Every source at once

Cost to raise a dollar, by month (cents)

All · Cents per $1



Months with an event (the gala, the Christmas appeal) jump. A gap means nothing was raised that month. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.